

Eurobioc2026 BiocContainer Report

BioHackathon series:

[Eurobioc 2026](#)

Turku, Finland 2026

[ContainerGroup](#)

Submitted: 02 Jun 2026

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Published by [BioHackrXiv.org](#)

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Introduction

Containers enhance reproducibility and additionally offer a convenient way to share the setup used and needed to run a script. Offering a way to create containers which contain desired R packages from within R allows users to more easily create these containers and work with them. R packages like `dockerfiler` offer functions to create and work with Docker files within R. However, currently there is no convenient way to create Docker files and containers from R while also controlling for the bioconductor release. The aim in this hackathon was to create a minimal set of functions that offer this possibility, and this work eventually gave rise to the R/Bioconductor package `SimpleBiocContainer`.

R/Bioconductor package `SimpleBiocContainer`

As part of the European Bioconductor Hackathon 2026, we created an R/Bioconductor package called `SimpleBiocContainer` which offers a more user friendly way to create, build and push Docker containers to [Dockerhub](#) from R. A working version of the package can be found on GitHub: (<https://github.com/lgatto/SimpleBiocContainer.git>).

The functions in `SimpleBiocContainer` make use of the existing Bioconductor docker containers which already contain a few packages, and additionally add the user-specified Bioconductor/R packages using `BiocManager::install()`. The Bioconductor version is inferred from the R session and the corresponding docker container matching that release is then used.

ToDo: describe the functions and what they do, maybe illustrate an example run. link to GH page of the package. I avoided naming the `makeSimpleBiocContainer` function for now, should this be explicitly mentioned or is it better not to be too detailed in case things change in the near future.

Conclusions / Future Work

get list of R packages loaded in session to create a container for those. add vignettes, further enhancements.

Acknowledgements

We thank all participants of the European Bioconductor Hackathon 2026 for the discussions. We also thank Nicholas Cooley and the organizing committee of the EuroBioC2026 conference



for organizing this event.

Author contributions